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Education for Sustainable Development

Prof. Atasi Mohanty
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Lecture 05: ESD

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CONCEPTS COVERED

- Education for Sustainable Development provides a valuable framework and methodology for achieving the goal of "quality education … for all" as stated in SDG 4.
- As a means of implementation, education is an important tool to support the achievement of each Sustainable Development Goal.
- "Education will be the lynchpin of a sustainable development agenda whose success relies on individuals, throughout their lifetime, acquiring relevant knowledge and developing positive attitudes to address global challenges".

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Unpacking SDG 4- Target 4.7

Goal 4: Ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all.

Target 4.7 Education for sustainability and global citizenship

by 2030 ensure all learners acquire knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including among others through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship, and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture's contribution to sustainable development

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- **What is ESD?**
- **Learning to Act; Learning to Achieve!!!!!**
- **ESD** empowers learners to take informed decisions and responsible actions for environmental integrity, economic viability and a just society, for present and future generations, while respecting cultural diversity. It is about lifelong learning, and is an integral part of quality education.
- **ESD** is holistic and transformational education, which addresses learning content and outcomes, pedagogy and the learning environment. It achieves its purpose by transforming society.
- "For countries and communities that embrace the need to bring quality education to all, the benefits are enormous" (UNESCO, 2015a: 2).
- Improving the quality of education can provide an even more significant boost to economic growth than simply increasing attainment,
- As countries achieve higher levels of education, they not only experience economic growth but also rapid increase in resource and energy usage.

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- Education for Sustainable Development extends its scope to deal with the complex amalgamation of issues relevant to environment, society and economy.

- ESD prepares people to cope with and find solutions to problems that threaten the sustainability of the planet.

- **Most ESD related topics were identified at the following conferences:**

- The Earth Summit at Rio de Janeiro in 1992 where issues regarding the sustainability of the planet were brought to the international discussion table; and

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- The World Summit on Sustainable Development (WSSD), held in Johannesburg in 2002, where it was recognized that education has in fact the capacity to put sustainability concerns at the centre of the learning context.
- At that Conference, governments agreed to reorient national education systems to a vision of sustainability that links economic well-being with respect for cultural diversity, the Earth and its resources
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=br0ukm_yOow

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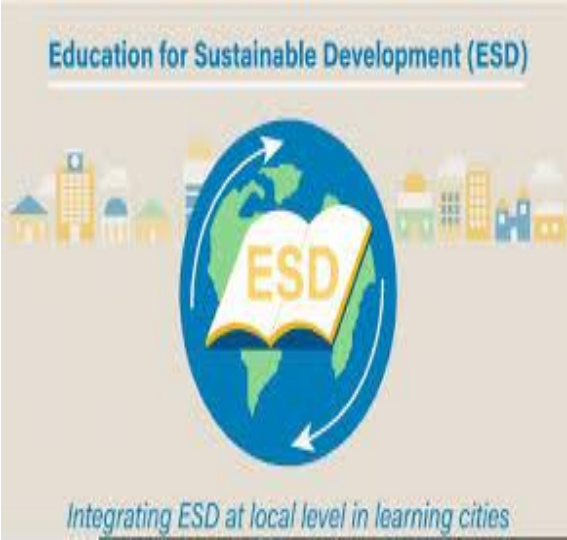
Environment
Energy
International Understanding
ESD Basic Philosophy
(Knowledge, values, behaviors, etc.)
Integrated environmental, economic, and societal development
Disaster Prevention
World Heritage Sites and Local Cultural Properties
Biodiversity
Other areas of study
Climate change

Environmental Education
Energy Education
Culture Education
Basic approach to ESD
Knowledge, values and action necessary for sustainable development
International Understanding Education
other related Education


Education for Sustainable Development (ESD)
ESD
Integrating ESD at local level in learning cities

- Improvements in the quality of education and equitable access to it can have a wide diversity of development benefits that demonstrate a high return on investment.
- Educational policies play a primary role in the effective implementation of ESD and framing how it influences and benefits the curriculum, teacher training, development of learning materials, and the learning environment.
- The 17 SDGs serve as “a comprehensive, far-reaching and people-centred set of universal and transformative goals and targets”1 with the aim of achieving them globally by 2030.
- Quality education for sustainable development has the potential to support transformative learning and bring about fundamental change.

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- “Quality education is about what and how people learn, its relevance to today’s world and global challenges, and its influence on people’s choices. Many now agree, quality education for sustainable development reinforces people’s sense of responsibility as global citizens and better prepares them for the world they will inherit” (UNESCO 2014: 28).
- “Across all levels and types of education – formal, non-formal, informal – ESD is also helping to advance the change in teaching and learning processes, bringing in approaches that ‘stimulate pupils to ask questions, analyze, think critically and make decisions,’ that are cooperative rather than competitive and that are more student-centred” (UNESCO 2014: 65).
- Education is an important means of implementation for sustainable development. It helps harmonize the tensions between economic, social and environmental development and integrate them into a single concept and pursuit.

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Essential characteristics of ESD

- based on the **principles and values** that underlie **sustainable development**
- ideals with the well-being of all three realms of sustainability **– environment, society and economy**
- promotes **lifelong learning**; locally relevant and **culturally appropriate**; based on local needs, perceptions and conditions, but acknowledges that **fulfilling local needs** often has international effects and consequences

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Essential characteristics of ESD

- engages **formal, non-formal and informal education**
- accommodates the evolving nature of the concept of **sustainability**
- addresses content, taking into account context, **global issues and local priorities**

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=X0zxvYwOvns

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Essential characteristics of ESD…contd..

- To create a **world that is more just, peaceful and sustainable**, all individuals and societies must be **equipped and empowered by knowledge, skills and values** as well as be instilled with a **heightened awareness** to drive such change. This is where education has a critical role to play. Education for Sustainable Development **(ESD) is about shaping a better tomorrow for all** – and it must start today.

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Essential characteristics of ESD

- **builds civil capacity** for community-based decision-making, social tolerance, environmental stewardship, adaptable workforce and **quality of life**
- is **interdisciplinary**: no one discipline can claim ESD as its own, but all disciplines can contribute to ESD
- uses a **variety of pedagogical techniques** that promote **participatory learning** and **higher-order thinking skills**.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AT9Lmw1HsOM

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ESD

- for achieving SDG 4.7

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- ‘**Declaration on the Right to Development**’ was implemented in **1986** by Member States of the United Nation
- The Declaration stated that everyone is ‘**entitled to participate in, contribute to, and enjoy economic, social, cultural and political development**, in which all human rights and fundamental freedoms can be fully realized.’ The Declaration also confirms that ‘States have the duty to cooperate with each other in ensuring development and eliminating obstacles to development.

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- **The right to development is not about charity, but enablement and empowerment**. The Declaration identifies obstacles to development, empowers individuals and peoples, calls for an enabling environment and good governance at both national and international levels, and enhances accountability of duty bearers – governments, donors and recipients, international organizations, transnational corporations, and civil society.

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- The year **2016 marks the Declaration's 30th anniversary**. Yet today many children, women and men – the very subjects of development – still live in dire need of the fulfilment of their entitlement to a life of dignity, freedom and equal opportunity. Widening poverty gaps, food shortages, climate change, global financial crises, corruption and the misappropriation of public funds, armed conflicts, rising unemployment, and other pressing challenges represent a collective failure to realize the right to development. And that failure in turn, directly affects the **realization of a wide range of civil, political, economic, social and cultural rights.**

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- "**Our common future**" "**sustainable development is a process of change** in which the exploitation of resources, the direction of investments, the orientation of technological development and institutional change are all in harmony and enhance both current and future potential to meet human needs and aspirations." (**Brundtland-Report,** p. 43).

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- This basic contribution to the subsequent global discussion reveals that the term development has often been associated exclusively with economic growth. But based on the above modelling of sustainability, the explanation of what sustainable development means is quite simple: **sustainable development describes the process of individuals and/or social groups to achieve sustainability**.

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- Or, to use the same metaphor in the context **of the interplay of HDI and ecologic footprint, sustainable development is the path leading into the green corner of the model** – from where ever an individual, social group or whole nation started.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=m7lStCVBf0A

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Measuring education for sustainable development: Experiences from the University of Bristol

- The purpose of this paper is to explore how education for sustainable development (ESD) was measured in the taught curriculum at the **University of Bristol (UoB),** providing comparison to other methods of measurement and how measurements were used to engage academics in considering the visibility of the penetration of **sustainable development into their teaching.**

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Measuring education for sustainable development : Experiences from the University of Bristol

- Text-based methods of assessing ESD penetration into program/s of study have limited use as direct measures of sustainability visibility in program/s, but can be improved by using interpretative methodologies. The combination of **quantitative and qualitative methodologies can produce data, which is a useful catalyst for academic reflection**.

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Measuring education for sustainable development : Experiences from the University of Bristol

- The UoB has avoided the pitfalls of manipulatable text count methods, and shown that comparative methods can be combined effectively with **real engagement with academics and students** for a measurement method that showcases **good practice**.

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- In **September 2015**, **170 world leaders** gathered at the UN Sustainable Development Summit in New York to **adopt the 2030 Agenda**. The new Agenda covers a broad set of **17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and 167 targets** and will serve as the overall framework to guide global and national development action **for the next 15 years**.

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- **Universal:** While the **MDGs** applied only to so-called '**developing countries**', the **SDGs** are a **truly universal** framework and will be applicable to **all countries**. All countries have progress to make in the path towards sustainable development, and face both common and unique challenges to achieving the many dimensions of sustainable development captured in the SDGs.

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- **Transformative:** As an agenda for "***people, planet, prosperity, peace and partnership***", the 2030 Agenda offers **a paradigm shift** from the traditional model of development. It provides a **transformative vision** for **people and planet**-centred, human rights-based, and gender-sensitive sustainable development that goes far beyond the narrow vision of the MDGs.

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- **Comprehensive:** Alongside a wide range of social, economic and environmental objectives, the 2030 Agenda promises "***more peaceful, just and inclusive societies which are free from fear and violence***" with attention to democratic governance, rule of law, access to justice and personal security (in **Goal 16**), as well as an enabling international environment (in **Goal 17** and throughout the framework). It therefore covers issues related to all human rights, including economic, civil, cultural, political, social rights and the right to development.

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- **Inclusive:** The new Agenda strives to leave no-one behind, envisaging "***a world of universal respect for equality and non-discrimination***" between and within countries, including gender equality, by reaffirming the responsibilities of all States to "*respect, protect and promote human rights, without distinction of any kind as to race, colour, sex, language, religion, political or other opinions, national and social origin, property, birth, disability or other status*."

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- It is increasingly recognized that human rights are essential to achieve sustainable development. The **Millennium Development Goals** (MDGs) served as a proxy for certain economic and social rights but ignored other important human rights linkages.

- From **Disparity to Dignity**: Tackling economic inequality through the Sustainable Development Goals, examines the human rights issues at stake in SDG10 and offers a set of rights-based policy proposals to ensure the promise of this goal is fulfilled. Drawing on human rights standards, the briefing explores a critical set of redistributive policies in the areas of social protection, health, education and taxation–that are key to tackling economic inequality from a human rights perspective. It also explains the equally crucial "pre-distributive" policies, such as employment and labor rights, care and family leave, and financial regulation.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=P0PZXZLGlUQ

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Sustainable development not possible if fellow humans are denied their rights, says UN DESA's Liu Zhenmin

The Universal Declaration proclaimed the inalienable rights of every human being regardless of race, colour, religion, sex, language, political or other opinion, national or social origin, property, birth or other status. It is the most translated document in the world, available in more than 500 languages.

Mr. Guterres noted humanity's considerable progress over the last seven decades. "People around the world have gained progressively greater freedoms and equality. They have been empowered to oppose discrimination, fight for protections, and gain greater access to justice, health, education and development opportunities. Conditions of profound economic misery and exploitation have been improved."

Mr. Liu added that the success of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development will depend on "building the resilience of the poorest, most vulnerable and those furthest behind." He reaffirmed UN DESA's commitment to supporting all Member States in eradicating poverty, creating decent jobs, providing quality healthcare and education, and achieving gender equality.

Also speaking at the event, the President of the United Nations General Assembly, Miroslav Lajčák, welcomed the launch of the year-long campaign, "which rallies us all to Stand Up for Human Rights. If we follow the news; if we talk to people from different backgrounds and countries; if we attend events in this building – then we know that a campaign like this is needed now more than ever," he said.

MPTEE

- **No quality education without human rights**

- **Human rights education (HRE) is a tool for building peaceful and just societies and States are held accountable for their HRE implementation through various global and regional conventions, resolutions, declarations and programs.**
- **Only by integrating human rights values into all aspects of schooling and education, can we promote a universal culture of justice, non-violence and equality.**
- **The Danish Institute for Human Rights is in consultation with The Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR) developing an HRE indicator framework to measure progress on national implementing the human rights education element of target 4.7.**

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- **Human rights and impact assessment**

- The Danish Institute for Human Rights is working on human rights and impact assessment (HRIA) in the following ways:
- Development of a Guide for integrating human rights in environmental, social and health impact assessment, in collaboration with IPIECA, the global oil and gas industry association for environmental and social issues
- Designing and facilitating a two-day Master class on integrating human rights in impact assessment, in collaboration with Community Insights Group
- Methodology development and facilitation of sector wide impact assessments (SWIA), in collaboration with the Myanmar Centre for Responsible Business and the Institute for Human Rights and Business
- Developing a HRIA Methodology Toolbox, comprising practical tools and guidance for undertaking HRIA of business projects

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Gender Equality

- Empowering women and promoting gender equality is crucial to accelerating sustainable development. Ending all forms of discrimination against women and girls is not only a basic human right, but it also has a multiplier effect across all other development areas.
- Since 2000, UNDP together with our UN partners and the rest of the global community has made gender equality central to our work, and we have seen some remarkable successes. More girls are now in school compared to 15 years ago, and most regions have reached gender parity in primary education. Women now make up to 41 percent of paid workers outside of agriculture, compared to 35 percent in 1990.
- Ensuring universal access to sexual and reproductive health, and affording women equal rights to economic resources such as land and property, are vital targets to realizing this goal. There are now more women in public office than ever before, but encouraging more women leaders across all regions will help strengthen policies and legislation for greater gender equality.

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Examples

- Oralia Ruano Lima was among the first women in her indigenous community to join an all-female entrepreneurship project as a beekeeper. Today the women beekeepers of Urlanta, a village in Guatemala, are bringing in sustainable jobs and income to their rural communities, and changing mindsets and attitudes towards women.
- Girls as young as seven flee female genital mutilation and other abuses in the Mara region of Tanzania, escape to a safe house which provides them shelter and protection. The UN Trust Fund to End Violence against Women has supported Amref Health Tanzania to launch an awareness raising and advocacy programme, aiming to end FGM practices
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K-oc4GOoWOI

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Joint Program on gender equality and women empowerment - Rural women economic empowerment component

The 2011 Gender and Development Index (GDI) placed Ethiopia in the 174th position out of 187 countries. Men are favored over women with regards to food, health care, education, and formal sector employment. Agriculture is a livelihood source for the majority of rural women and men.

The SDG Fund program on Rural Women´s Economic Empowerment has been developed to accelerate economic empowerment of rural women in 2 regions, Afar and Oromia. It has been developed as a separate and differentiated component of the Joint Program on Gender Equality and Women Empowerment implemented by the Government of Ethiopia and UN agencies, and coordinated by UN Women.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nEHjxMXHe2E

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KEYWORDS

- **ESD for Peace & Non-Violence:**
- **The overall goal of the DESD (Decade of Education for Sustainable Development) is to integrate the principles, values and practices of sustainable development into all aspects of education and learning. This educational effort will encourage changes in behavior that will create a more sustainable future in terms of environmental integrity, economic viability, and a just society for present and future generations. (UNESCO-DESD 2005-14)**

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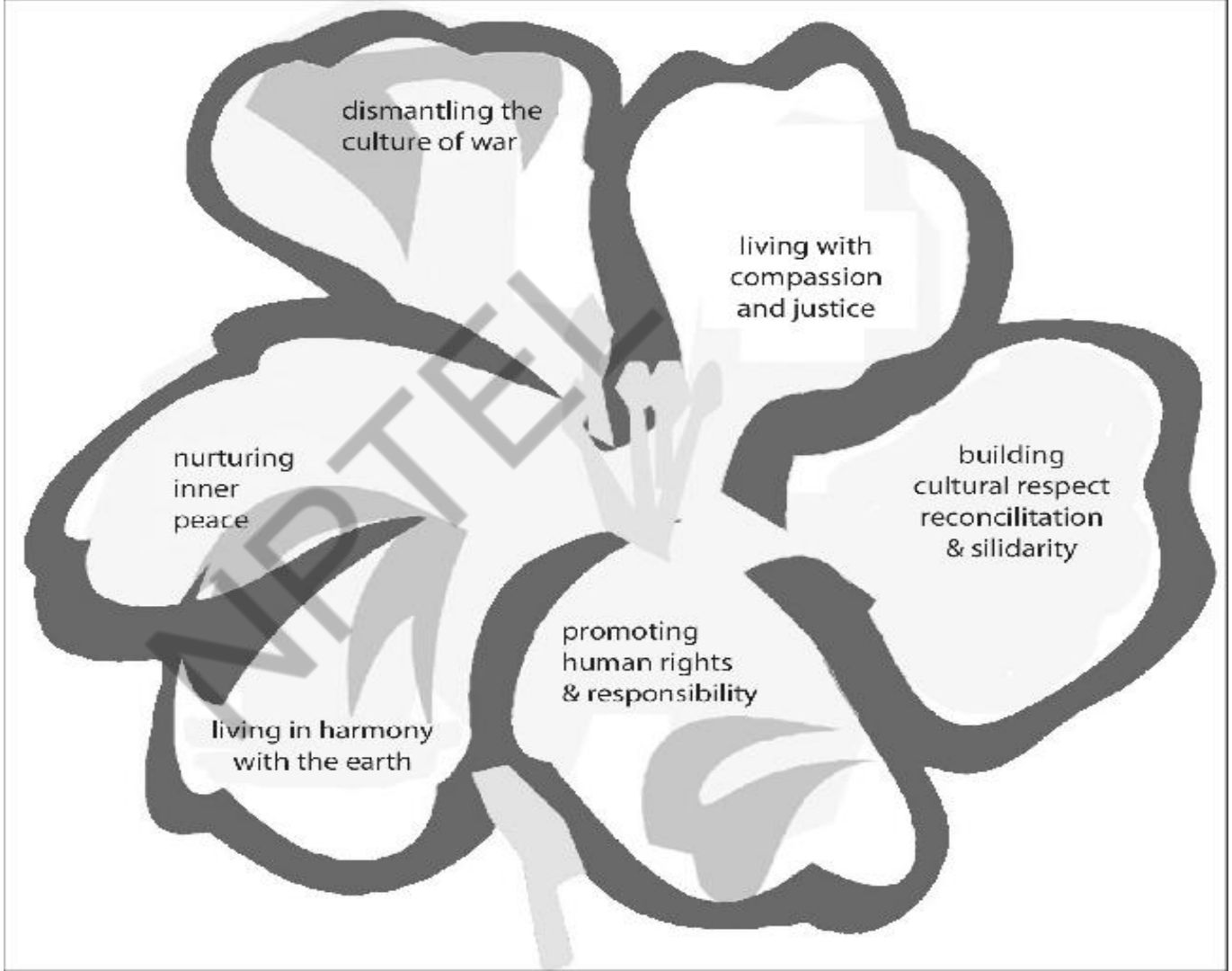
A holistic framework of peace education-
Source: Toh 2004, p.30



- **Culture of Peace and Non-violence**

UNESCO, since 1945, has promoted the right to quality education and the advancement of science and its applications to develop knowledge and capacity for economic and social progress, the basis of peace and sustainable development.

International cooperation is promoted through programmes on the management of transboundary sites such as World Heritage sites, biosphere reserves and geoparks, and of transboundary water resources, as well as Water for Peace programmes such as From Potential Conflict to Cooperation Potential (PCCP).

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- **Culture of Peace and Non-violence**

UNESCO is leading the United Nations International Year of Water Cooperation 2013(link is external), to promote deeper cooperation to tackle the rising demand for water access, allocation and services.

While opportunities for sustainable development in Africa are growing, the continent still faces many challenges including the risk of major instability and conflict. UNESCO advocates for the promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence in Africa based on African shared values.

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Objectives

Strengthening	• Strengthening peace and non-violence through education, advocacy and media including ICTs and social networks
Developing	• Developing the use of heritage and contemporary creativity as tools for building peace through dialogue
Strengthening	• Strengthening social cohesion and contributing to the African Renaissance through the introduction of the General History of Africa into formal and non-formal education settings
Promoting	• Promoting scientific and cultural cooperation for the management of natural trans boundary resources
Empowering and engaging	• Empowering and engaging young people, women and men

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Flagship Program 1:
Promoting a culture of peace and non-violence

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- **Overall Objective**

•Address the root causes of conflicts in Africa and strengthen the capacity to prevent and resolve conflicts peacefully in particular using African local values and endogenous practices of a culture of peace.

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- **Main actions**

- Scale up education for a culture of peace by mainstreaming peace, human rights and global citizenship education in particular in the following areas: curriculum, teacher education, teaching materials and learning environments
- Promote knowledge and capacity for protecting and sustainably managing the ocean and coasts through the development of appropriate management tools for cross-border cooperation frameworks with a particular focus on the main hydrological basins in Africa and for the sustainable use of ecosystems shared by states

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- Strengthen capacities of Member States to design and implement multi-stakeholder and inclusive public youth policies and engage young women and men in community building and democratic processes •
- Introduce the General History of Africa into the curriculum of formal and non-formal education systems
- Promote elements of the African intangible heritage for reconciliation, social cohesion and peace
- Facilitate pluralistic media institutions empower youth through enhanced media and information literacy competencies
- Raise awareness of youth for peace and dialogue through social media

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Results

Education to peace, citizenship, democracy and human rights is integrated into formal and non-formal teaching and learning systems and reinforce mutual understanding and social cohesion

The empowerment, civic engagement and democratic participation of young African women and men are promoted through inclusive youth policies and youth-led programmes on a culture of peace.

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- **Role of Education in Promoting Peace, Sustainable Development and Global Citizenship**

- **Education for Sustainable Development plays a key role in promoting values for peace.**
- **Creating a world culture of peace requires the involvement of all parties in the society that together shape the world's culture – institutions such as the United Nations system, governments, politicians, scientists, NGOs, the media, civil society, and especially teachers and parents.**

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- Although peace education is often based in schools and other learning environments, it should involve the entire community, as peace education is not only a necessity in areas where there are conflicts, but in all societies.
- Parents are especially important: they must encourage strong family values that foster a culture of peace.

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- **Education for Sustainable Development: MGIEP's Framework for 21st Century**

- **Education for Sustainable Development and Peace** develops people's skills to take action that improves our quality of life now and for future generations. As the starting point for developing its framework for the 21st century, it would be meaningful for MGIEP to recognize the fact that there are several crucial questions/issues facing people in all societies.

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These include:

- how to preserve and protect the environment, reduce pollution and manage natural resources in a sustainable way
- how to reduce the inequalities that exist between different people in all parts of the world and protect their human rights and
- how to develop peaceful and harmonious communities by promoting understanding between people who are different from one another.

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- The Role of Education in Promoting Sustainable Developmen t and Peace

- Education for Sustainable Development (ESD) in many forms has permeated most systems of education across the globe.
- The Recommendation of the International Conference on Education (IBE: 2001) to promote Education for International Understanding (EIU) was the first international document giving concrete guidelines to educational authorities and practitioners on how to promote education for international understanding on a global scale.

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- What is the tool that would allow us to achieve such a mission? What does an "education of humanity for justice and liberty and peace" imply? Is mere literacy sufficient?

- It gave special emphasis to trying to adopt a common and universal approach beyond politico-ideological divisions, socio-economic gaps, and different educational concepts and strategies. (Lawrence Surendra)

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- The enterprise of education at its most profound level is transformative.
- Education provides the critical link in understanding the connections between sustainability and peace.
- It sharpens and builds people's skills to take action that improves our quality of life now and for future generations.
- If institutions, teachers, and learners in every national context are made aware of and understand the connections between sustainability and peace in their own societies and the implications of these connections for global peace and sustainability and vice versa,

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- SDGs reaffirmed the need to improve education and ensure all people are afforded a high standard of education.
- Education has two critical roles to play in supporting the implementation of the SDGs.
- First, education is addressed as a standalone goal in SDG 4 especially as a primary driver of human development.
- Second, education is also understood as a highly effective means of implementation across all of the Goals by serving as a vehicle to raise awareness, increase knowledge, and develop capacity of actors around the world to play active roles in the work of the 2030 Development Agenda.
- Improvements to the quality of education can catalyze the transformative learning needed for realizing a sustainable future for all.

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- **The 17 SDGs serve as *"a comprehensive, far-reaching and people-centred set of universal and transformative goals and targets"* with the aim of achieving them globally by 2030.**
- Quality education for sustainable development has the potential to support transformative learning and bring about fundamental change.
- In order to achieve this, countries must first consider how to develop plans and actions that will harness education as a powerful means of implementation, and ultimately reform education policy towards the advancement of sustainable development.

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- ESD can thus help address the fact that as countries achieve higher levels of education, they not only experience economic growth but also rapid increase in resource and energy usage
- It helps harmonize the tensions between economic, social and environmental development and integrate them into a single concept and pursuit.

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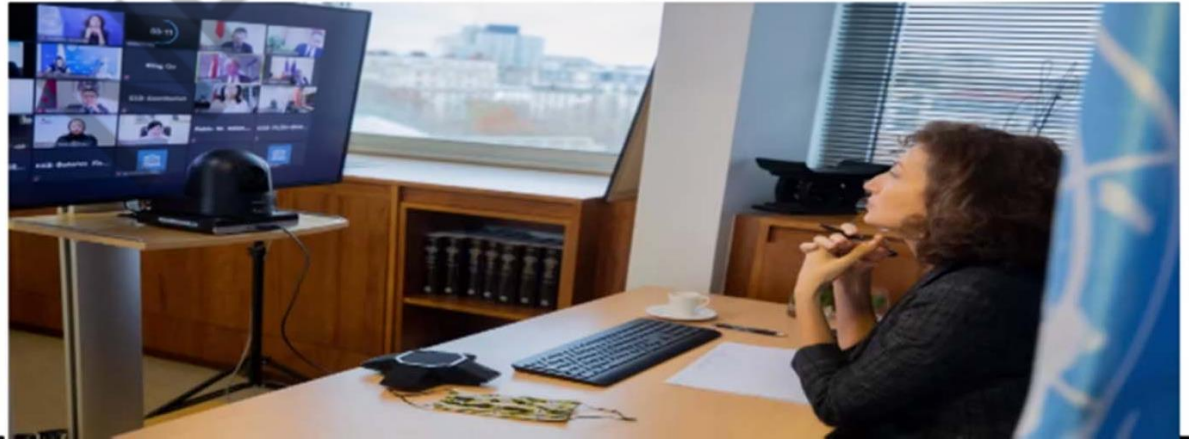
"Quality education is about what and how people learn, its relevance to today's world and global challenges, and its influence on people's choices. Many now agree, quality education for sustainable development reinforces people's sense of responsibility as global citizens and better prepares them for the world they will inherit" (UNESCO 2014: 28).

UNESCO Director-General Audrey Azoulay charts a new strategic direction

https://en.unesco.org/news/unesco-director-general-audrey-azoulay-charts-new-strategic-direction

UNESCO Director-General, Audrey Azoulay , addressing the 210th session of the Executive Board, the very first to be held online in the history of UNESCO



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- Education communicates the value of natural and indigenous heritage
- UNESCO's World in 2030 survey revealed that respondents across all regions see climate change and biodiversity loss as the top global challenge in the lead up to 2030
- According to Denise Alvarez, addressing the joint issues of climate change and biodiversity loss is intrinsically linked to the protection of indigenous cultures and knowledges, and cooperation with indigenous peoples.
- The translation of these values into effective public policy and holistic education programming, is key to repairing humanity's relationship with nature.

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- Conservation of the environment implicitly linked to protection of indigenous rights
- It is vital that we protect our cultures; the guardians of the forest, and all this knowledge is in them; it is oral, it does not have a library. Exmpl. during COVID-19 some chiefs have died, and with them wisdom: knowledge of forest management and conservation, and all those [biodiverse] plants and animals.
- Hence, we must encourage the implementation of public policies for the preservation of the environment and indigenous peoples.
- Education for indigenous peoples-Guided by the new UNESCO Policy on Engaging with Indigenous Peoples, UNESCO is committed to promote lifelong learning for indigenous peoples and ensure their full inclusion in education.
- https://en.unesco.org/themes/inclusion-in-education/indigenous

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